

A yellow square containing the letters 'JS' in a bold, black, sans-serif font.

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition • 2024 Analysis • Best of JS Curated Projects

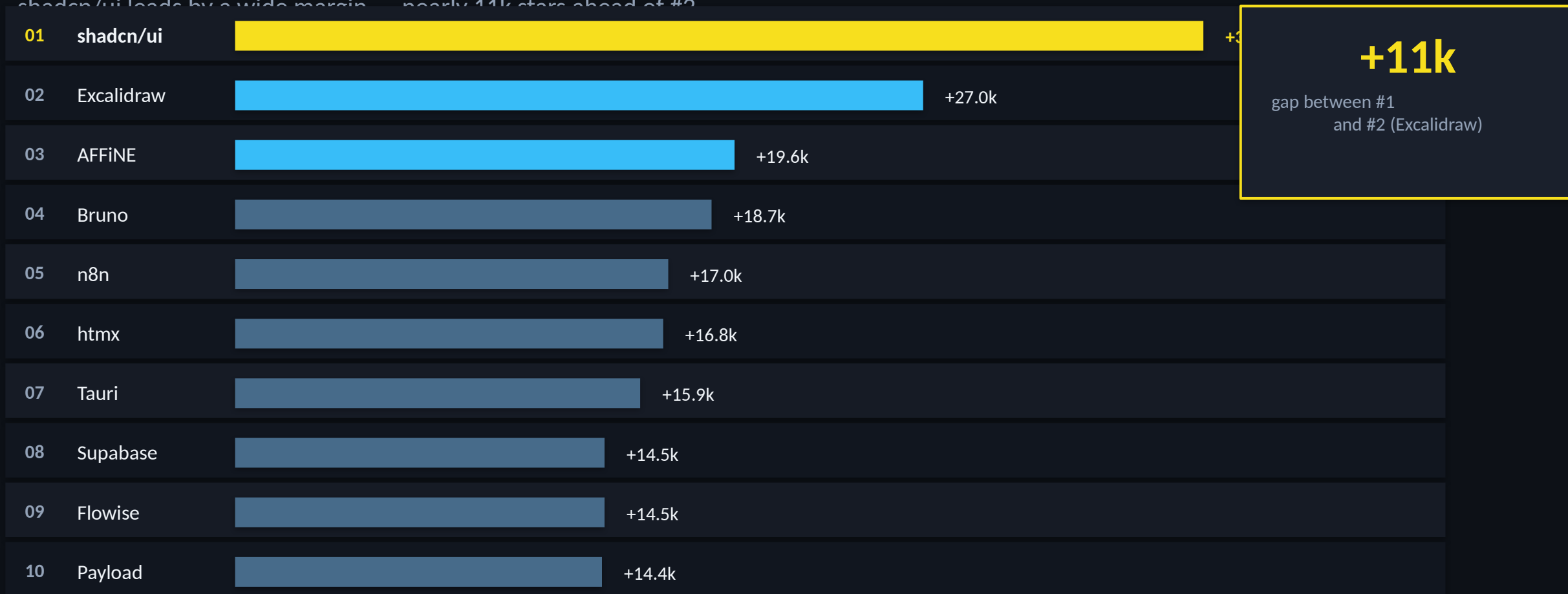
Methodology: GitHub stars added January – December 2024

Projects curated by Best of JS • Source: risingstars.js.org/2024/en

For: Frontend Engineers & Engineering Managers

Top 10 Projects by GitHub Stars Added in 2024

shadcn/ui leads by a wide margin — nearly 11k stars ahead of #2



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

Total: 77.5k stars • Created January 2023

Stars Added per Year

+39.5k

+38.0k

Jan 2024 peak: +7.3k • Steady 2-3k/month throughout the year

77.5k total stars • #1 for the 2nd consecutive year

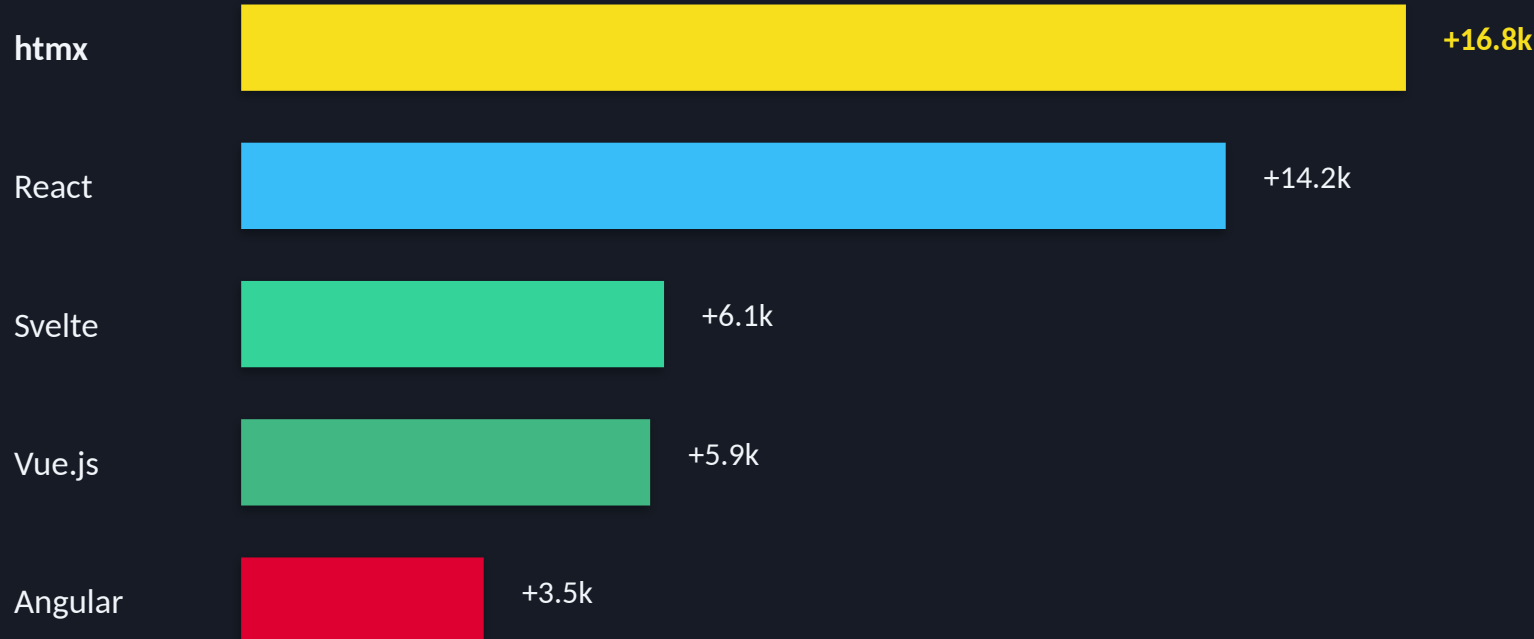
Key 2024 Additions

- Charts — powered by Recharts
- Themes — CSS variable generation
- Blocks — layout collections for typical web apps
- New responsive Sidebar component
- Upgraded CLI: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos
- CLI installs components, themes, hooks, utils & dependencies
- Registry ecosystem: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI
- Vercel v0 AI-generated component integration

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added

2024 rankings reveal growing appetite for server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures

Stars Added in 2024



htmx Philosophy

Extends HTML with `hx-*` attributes for AJAX & WebSockets — no JavaScript needed.

React 19 (Dec 2024)

Server Components, Server Functions, Custom Elements, new hooks & form actions after 3 years.

Svelte 5 Runes

Explicit reactive state via runes. Highest positive opinion in State of JS survey.

React → Spec

Robin Wieruch: React is evolving into a specification for frameworks, not just a library.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

Top 5 projects by stars added — React's orbit extends well beyond the core library

1	shadcn/ui +38.0k stars		Copy-paste UI components — own & customize your code
2	Excalidraw +27.0k stars		Virtual whiteboard for hand-drawn style diagrams
3	Payload +14.4k stars		Open-source fullstack Next.js CMS framework
4	Magic UI +13.2k stars		Animation-first component library built on shadcn/ui
5	Next.js +12.1k stars		The de-facto React meta-framework with App Router

React 19 Evolution:

Server Components + Server Functions make React 19 a full-stack specification. Next.js, Remix, and others now interpret React primitives differently. The React Compiler continues development for DX & performance gains.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead

Growth

Vue 3.5 reactivity rework + wave of quality UI libraries signals ecosystem maturity

1	Nuxt +6.2k stars		Vue meta-framework — active release cycle & performance focus
2	PrimeVue +5.4k stars		Comprehensive UI component library for Vue 3
3	Slidev +4.7k stars		Markdown-driven presentation tool built on Vite + Vue
4	shadcn-vue +4.1k stars		Vue port of shadcn/ui — component ownership model for Vue
5	VitePress +3.7k stars		Vite-powered static site generator for documentation

Vue 3.5 Highlights

- Reactivity system reworked (alien-signals approach)
- alien-signals already merged to main branch
- Lighter, faster reactive primitives
- Surge of high-quality UI libs (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue)
- Daniel Roe (Nuxt): active release cycle & regular perf wins

Vue's UI library wave mirrors React's 2021-2022 boom — a lagging indicator of ecosystem health.

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape

2024

Four of the top 10 projects have significant AI capabilities or integrations

AI-Powered Tooling

- n8n +17.0k — workflow automation with native AI
- Flowise +14.5k — drag & drop LLM flow builder
- AFFiNE +19.6k — Notion + Miro with AI integration
- Supabase +14.5k — open-source backend with AI hooks
- 4 of top 10 = AI-adjacent projects

Desktop & Native

- Tauri +15.9k — lightweight desktop/mobile apps
- Web frontend + Rust backend = lean binaries
- Challenge to Electron's dominance continues

Browser Innovation

- PGLite — Postgres via WebAssembly in the browser
- WebVM — full virtual machine running in browser
- Expanding what 'web app' can mean without a server

Developer Productivity

- Bruno +18.7k — open-source Postman alternative
- Excalidraw +27.0k — collaborative diagramming
- shadcn/ui CLI spawning registry ecosystem

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

Five signals for engineering teams planning their 2025 stack

- 01 Component ownership beats imports**
shadcn/ui's model (copy code into your repo, own it) won for a second year with 77.5k total stars. Expect more libraries to ship code-ownership variants.
- 02 HTML-first is serious**
htmx overtook React as the #1 framework by stars. Server-driven, low-JS architectures have a growing, vocal audience. Not a niche anymore.
- 03 React is becoming a framework specification**
React 19 Server Components + Server Functions mean frameworks interpret React primitives differently. React is now a spec as much as a library.
- 04 AI integration is table stakes**
4 of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFINE) have significant AI capabilities. Pure-utility libraries without AI hooks face rising expectations.
- 05 Vue's ecosystem maturity**
PrimeVue, shadcn-vue, Nuxt's active cycle, and Vue 3.5 reactivity rework signal a confident maturing ecosystem that's closing the DX gap with React.

→ 2025 Watch: AI-native UI generators, Tauri 2.x mobile reach, WebAssembly DB primitives, and framework-as-spec patterns across the ecosystem.